seasoning and preservation. Spoilage of pickle is prevented by the addition of salt and spices.

c) Pickles Preserved by Lemon Juice: Vegetables and garlic pickles made with lime juice adds taste.

d) Vinegar Pickle: Vinegar is a dilute acetic acid. Vinegar is used as a preservative for preparing tomato sauces, tomato pickle, chilli sauce and meat pickle.

e) Sweet Pickle: Sweet pickle is prepared by adding garam masala powder and sugar to fruits and sweet vegetables. Vegetables and fruits should be soaked in sweet vinegar and boiled for 5 to 6 minutes and mixed well, cooled and packed in the jar.

III. Types of Spoilage in Pickles

Table 6.2 Spoilage of Preserved Pickles

S.no	Defect	Cause	Prevention
1	Shrivelling	Placing vegetables like cucumber directly in a very strong solution of salt or sugar and vinegar	Weak solutions should be used to start with, increasing their strength gradually.
2	Bitter taste	Use of strong vinegar, prolonged cooking of spices, Over spicing	Adding adequate vinegar and spices
3	Blackening	Iron entering through the brine or from the equipment, mould growth	Use of stainless steel equipment and dry spoons
4	Scum formation	Growth of wild yeast, growth of putrefactive bacteria causing the vegetables to become soft and slippery.	Maintain sufficient acidity
5	Cloudiness	Chemical reaction between vinegar and the minerals such as calcium, magnesium or iron.	Use of stainless steel equipment
6	Stickiness	Certain bacteria that thrive in salt but not in acid	Maintain sufficient acidity
7	Fermentation	Yeast growth	Cover the jars with tight lids, keep jars under Sun to destroy yeast
8	Flabbiness	Blanching for long time, prolonged cooking	Blanch for 2–3 minutes, use adequate time for cooking
9	Mould growth	Insufficient salt, spices and oil, surface moisture not completely evaporated after blanching, jars not sterilized properly, jars stored in a hot moist place	Use adequate salt, spices and oil, keep the blanched vegetables/fruit under Sun to evaporate the moisture completely, sterilize the jars properly, store in a cool dry place, oil should be 1 or 2 inches above the pickles
10	Dull and faded colour	Use of over mature and poor quality vegetables and fruits	Use just ripe, firm vegetables and fruits free from any cuts and blemishes.

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